

Friends of Badger Park—Newsletter

Summer 2024

Welcome!

Welcome to our very first newsletter. We thought that we had reached a point where we should update people on our achievements as a local community group and also share with you our successes (and set-backs) so far.

Looking back on the timeline of activities has reminded us of just how far we have come, and also how reliant we are on the good will of everyone who volunteers their time as part of our committee. We are still wanting new members to join so if you are able to meet with us (we don't meet very regularly) and help out at some of our events, we would love to hear from you. Drop us an email (friendsofbadgerpark@gmail.com)

Anyway, enough of that! Grab a cuppa and get ready to be blown away with what we have achieved so far!

It all started in August 2020

Friends of Badger Park formed in August 2020, set up by local residents to help raise funds to replace the playground after Chesterfield Borough Council advised it was being removed due to health and safety concerns. We wanted to improve the park for the whole community. The first meeting took place in **September 2020** with the objective of raising at least £3,000 to access further funding of up to £30,000 to replace the play equipment on the park. Park demolition also began that same month. By October, donations began coming in, along with grant funding. The group opened an account with the Open Collective to receive funding. At this point we increased our goal of fundraising to £5,000 and had a total of £490 already!

In **October 2020** (it was a busy month!), online questionnaires were made available for public input into plans and bulb planting took place on the park. We planted 5,000 daffodil bulbs in conjunction with Chesterfield Borough Council. We continued throughout October to raise funds and managed to get an article in the Derbyshire Times and the Derby Telegraph to support our efforts.

We secured another article about our cause in the Derbyshire Times in **November** and also spent time sharing our vision for the park and collecting through donation buckets in Morrisons supermarket.

Realising we needed to do more to raise money, (in a difficult time as we were mid-pandemic) we launched a raffle to raise funds and were blown away by the generosity of local businesses and individuals. We raised a total of £1,441 which was incredible.

December brought some great news. We had been awarded £5,000 from Chesterfield Borough Council from the International Levy Fund, bringing our grand total for fundraising to £7,000.



The old park, before demolition in Sept 2020



Photos from the bulb planting in October 2020





Friends of Badger Park

Christmas Raffle

£1 per ticket

Top Prizes Include...

- Handmade Footstool from Rebuilt by Humans worth £150
- Lacoste Bluetooth Headphones worth £40
- £150 of Temple Spa products
- £150 of ESPA products
- And many more...

Closing Date: 18th Dec to be drawn on 19th Dec

How to buy tickets...

- Donate via our Open Collective page and you will automatically be entered
- Cash payment is also available please contact Katherine Hollingworth using the below details

<https://opencollective.com/friends-of-badger-park>

Katherine.hollingworth@chesterfield.gov.uk
01246 270835

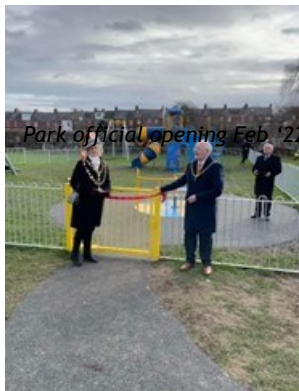
Lottery Licence Number 510198



Get in touch if you want to help in any way: friendsofbadgerpark@gmail.com



The official opening of the new park in Feb 2022



Park official opening Feb '22

**Links to some of our news stories
that have been published**

<https://www.derbytelegraph.co.uk/news/local-news/playground-stripped-dangerous-equipment-ensure-4644120>

<https://www.derbyshiretimes.co.uk/news/people/hopes-to-build-something-better-at-chesterfield-park-after-dangerous-play-area-removed-3017746>

<https://www.derbyshiretimes.co.uk/news/people/chesterfield-residents-launch-campaign-to-replace-unsafe-playground-3034252>

2021—the story continues....

The year started well with a £200 donation received from A F Blakemore & Son Ltd taking our collective fundraising total to over £8,000! At this point we were busy working with Chesterfield Borough Council to complete the funding application including feedback from public consultation.

It was in March that we started to get excited and ran a playground design competition with local primary schools. This month we also ran our first Easter Treasure Hunt on the park.

By April we had letters of support from residents for the grant application and in June, we continued the fun on the park, with bat and bird box making. A session that was supported by Chesterfield Borough Council.

July 2021 was a highlight in our timeline as not only did we host the first 'Games on the Park' but we were informed that the funding bid for the new park had been successful!



The winning design

In October we held the Halloween Xplorer and Giant Land Art events with more support from Chesterfield Borough Council.

By November, we had the drawings and plans for the new park which we shared with the community.



Work began on the park in December 2021 and was ready to open in January 2022! We held the official opening in February on a cold but fantastic day of celebration.

Since then we have had a bench installed (March '22), done Easter Egg hunts every year. We held a jubilee picnic in the park in June '22 and held a tree planting festival in October '22.

Into 2023.....

Going from strength to strength we did more

planting in February 2023, and held our first full sports day in June with half term fun including sunflowers and minibeasts. The highlight of 2023 has to be the colour run in August where we were overwhelmed by the amount of people that turned up to become a human rainbow!

May saw our first set-back when the community orchard we planted was vandalised and the saplings were deliberately snapped and broken. This shook the team and the community, trying to understand why someone would want to cause such damage however that was overshadowed somewhat in October when devastation struck and an arson attack blew out the slide and damaged a significant amount of the playground. An act of violence that we are still recovering from now.

2024—the mission continues Not be to deterred though, the community group is stronger than ever and continue to plan events, fundraise and help to create a fabulous community space for everyone.

WATCH THIS SPACE FOR MORE UPDATES AND ONGOING INFORMATION ABOUT EVENTS